

tions become easier to assess. So scientists could potentially build a breed of nanobots programmed with a Weak AI that can diagnose and treat human ailments in a jiffy. A futuristic scenario of this is injecting a few nanobots into a part of your body so that they can quickly scan and diagnose the problem and treat it immediately – all without requiring any “free” thought as such.

Every conversation about artificial intelligence eventually brings up Isaac Asimov and I, Robot, so let’s take a look at Strong AI and Weak AI in that

context. When you talk about Asimov’s “Three Laws of Robotics”, they’re designed as an over-riding counter-balance for any task a robot in the future is to perform. If the task doesn’t meet one of the three laws, the robot won’t perform it. This is a classic example of Weak AI.

But the base plot of a robot that starts thinking beyond those three laws is a prime example of Strong AI. The artificial intelligence is thinking independently – “freely” – much in the way a human does.



Alan Turing

The Turing Test

While we use the word “think” to illustrate any process of rational or irrational reasoning, it isn’t a perfect definition. Artificial intelligence often gets loosely labelled as “a machine’s ability to think for itself”. But what do we mean by “think” in this case?

Is it the ability to process data to come up with an output? Does that output have to meet criteria of right and wrong?

